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Cavs bounce back

By BOB FINNAN

bfinnan@MorningJournal.com

CLEVELAND — Fans have come to appreciate the Cavaliers' resiliency this season.

In games following a loss, the Cavs are now 12-1 on the season.

The Miami Heat had the misfortune of being the next team on the schedule after the Cavs' disappointing defeat in Boston on Friday when they just didn't compete.

The Cavs (49-13) bounced back in a big way on Saturday in their 99-89 victory before 20,562 at Quicken Loans Arena.

"It's something we've been able to do this year," Cavs forward LeBron James said. "We have been able to bounce back after losses this year. It's positive to see."

James recorded his fourth triple-double of the season and 21st of his career with 14 points, 10 rebounds and 12 assists. The league office won't be taking this one away.

"For me, I felt good when I worked out earlier," James said. "But as the game went on and on, my jumper and legs didn't feel particularly well. I tried to do the other things that I know I can do - defend, get guys open and get guys shots. I can still find ways to contribute to our team."

But James was anything but the only shining star. Guard Mo Williams was scorching hot with a game-high 29 points. He connected on 6 of 7 from behind the arc.

Williams has shot 73 percent from 3-point land in his last five games (19 of 26).

The win gives the Cavs a 3-1 record in the season series against the Heat and comes five days after the showdown in Miami between James and Dwyane Wade when the MVP candidates combined for 83 points.

It was more subdued on Saturday, even though Wade wasn't around for the finish. He was ejected for the first time in his career with 50.3 seconds left for complaining about a no-call on the offensive end.

Wade finished with 25 points, 12 assists, eight rebounds and four steals. He made 9 of 23 from the field.

The Cavs sped out to a 20-point cushion and waited for the Heat to make their run. That came in the third quarter when they outscored the Cavs, 26-20. Mario

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Olmsted Falls 80, Admiral King 77

King overthrown



MATE PAULSONS/MORNING JOURNAL

Admiral King's AJ Atkinson reacts to the Admirals' 80-77 loss to Olmsted Falls in the Midview District Division I playoffs at Midview High School.

Late Admirals rally not enough

By ANTHONY RIOS

arios@MorningJournal.com

EATON TWP. — All season Admiral King had forced its opponents to play its style of basketball for 32 minutes.

Unfortunately, Olmsted Falls was up for the task ... and then some.

The Bulldogs used a hot shooting in first quarter and handled Admirals full-court press the entire game. Though the Admirals showed a lot of heart in battling back from a huge early deficit and foul trouble, their magical season came to an end with a 80-77 loss in the Division I sectional finals.

"We dug ourselves in a hole in the first half, but we allowed them to shoot some shots," Admirals coach Al Stacey said. "We didn't play the defense we wanted to play. We didn't switch out to get to out on their shooters and we corrected it at halftime."

"We made them take some tough shots in the second half and we made it interesting," Stacey added. "In the end they made the plays at the end and we didn't."

The Admirals (21-1) scored on the first play the game

and didn't get lead back until 5:17 left in the game at 67-65 on a Adrian Solis basket.

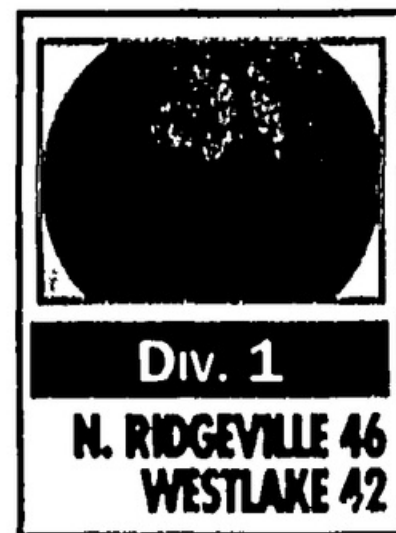
Olmsted Falls' Tony Lanza hit a 3-pointer on the next possession to put the Bulldogs back on top by one. Bryant Parker's lay-up gave the lead back to the Admirals at 69-68.

Admiral King had a chance to increase its lead, but Malcolm Barnett miss-fired on a pair of free throws. The misses turned out to be a trend for the Admirals as they shot just 2 of 11 in the fourth quarter, and 18 of 35 for the game.

"It was horrendous," said Stacey about the free throws. "I think that really cost us the game."

With Admiral King struggling from the line, the Bulldogs (13-8) were able to take a 74-71 lead with 2:38 remaining. After a steal and lay-up by Vincent Lee, Parker stole the inbound pass and was fouled attempting the go-ahead score. He split the free throws and the game was knotted 74-74 with just over a minute to go.

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Rangers sneak by Westlake

By JAMES BRADY

sbrady@MorningJournal.com

EATON TWP. — Come tournament time, all that matters is getting a win and surviving to the next round.

North Ridgeville got stuck playing a slow-down game with Westlake, but in the end, the Rangers had just enough to beat the Demons, 46-42, to advance to the district semifinals next Wednesday against Olmsted Falls after the Bulldogs shocked Admiral King, 80-77, in the opener last night.

"We couldn't get into a flow because of their (Westlake) defense," Rangers head coach Bill Noggle said. "They are a well coached team and they kept us from doing what we wanted to do."

"Having (Drew) McGhee in foul trouble certainly hurt us, but Keene Cockburn stepped up real big for him and Jason Ice gave us some big minutes."

What North Ridgeville wanted to do was get the ball inside to center Drew McGhee, but that didn't work out as McGhee faced foul trouble and had to sit nearly half the contest. McGhee finished with nine points, eight rebounds and three blocked shots.

With McGhee struggling, the Rangers found a helping hand in Cockburn who netted 18 points on 7 of 14 shooting from the floor.

The first half was a lesson in offensive patience and a lot of passing as the two teams combined for only 33 points with the Rangers taking a slim 17-16 lead at the half.

The game was cruising along nicely with Westlake taking an early 8-6 lead following a Jason Labroo 3-pointer with 2:50 left on the first quarter clock. Labroo finished with 10 points, including three triples. Alex Pandrang also closed the game with 10 points and nine rebounds.

Shortly after the 3-pointer, the Demons' 6-foot-7 center Shane Skelly picked up two fouls in a 20-second span and that seemed to give the Rangers an advantage as Cockburn took a blocked shot down the middle against the Westlake defense for a huge dunk.

Any height advantage held by the Rangers was wiped out when the 6-foot-11 McGhee was whistled for his second foul just 32 seconds later. With both big men on the bench for the remainder of the half, neither

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Pioneers fall short in bid for district crown

By TODD SHAPIRO

tshapiro@MorningJournal.com

MEDINA — Before yesterday's Division I district final game, Westlake coach Chip Weiss went over the three goals his team set at the beginning of the season. Now he can check off goal No. 3.

The Demons defeated Elyria 47-30 to win the Medina District title, improve their record to 22-2 and advance to the Norwalk regional.

"At the beginning of the year we set out accomplish three things," Westlake coach Chip Weiss said. "Go undefeated, win the Southwestern Conference and win the district title. I'm pretty happy with two out of three."

The Pioneers jumped out to a quick 7-1 lead, only to see Westlake score eight straight point to retake the lead 9-7. The Demons never relinquished the lead again.

"When we got up we had a few chances to extend the lead," Elyria coach Mike Walsh said. "But give Westlake credit, they are a great basketball team. They came back and forced us into some turnovers and took over the game."

Westlake led by one, 15-14 at the end of the first period.

That was when the Demons defense took over, holding Elyria to just one second quarter point ... a Tess Sito free throw.

Elyria went almost 12 minutes without a field goal until Sarita Seymore hit a jumper with 4:24 remaining in the third.

Despite their offensive struggles, the Pioneers defense kept them in the game until late in the third quarter.

"In a district championship game you want both teams to come out and play their best," Walsh said. "Unfortunately, for us, it just didn't happen today."

Elyria played the game without sophomore point

guard Cynthia Woodard, who was using crutches after injuring her knee in Thursday's district semifinal win over Amherst.

"We are just playing for Cynthia right now," Walsh said. "She hasn't been able to get an MRI yet because there is too much swelling. I just hope this won't interfere with her softball season."

Tal Dotson led the Pioneers with 12 points and 12 rebounds.

Sito finished with nine points, including a 3-pointer in the first period.

"As a senior it's hard to end this way again," Sito said. "We had a good year. We won the Holiday Tournament and won our league (Northeast Ohio Conference Valley Division). The hardest part in knowing we didn't play our best game today."

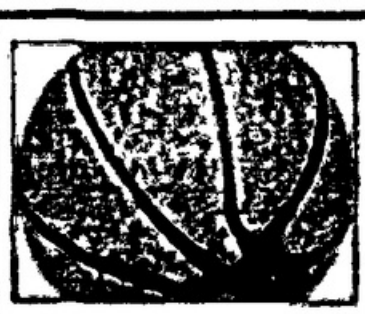
Elyria has advanced to the district finals three of the past four seasons, losing the championship game each time.

Senior Rosa LaMattina led Westlake with 13 points despite picking up three first-half fouls for the second consecutive game.

Lauryn Smith also had 11 points for the Demons.

"This means everything," Smith said of winning the district championship. "Elyria is a really good team. We knew we would have to play well as a team to win this today and that's what we did. The support we got from our fans really got us pumped up too."

The Pioneers end their season with an 18-5 record.



MORNING JOURNAL/JOE BUECK

From right to left, Tess Sito, Brigitte Jones, Kortney Schweitzer, and Tal Dotson wait out the final seconds of the game. Elyria lost to Westlake 47-30.